

Chapter 51_2: Baili Shi Qi

"What's your name? I think you're older than me—how about I call you elder sister?" The young lady's deer-like spirited eyes stared at Ning Fu Yi, "Are you also here alone to eliminate ghosts?"

"Ning Fu Yi, I came with my aunt." Ning Fu Yi answered, then signaled her to keep her voice down, using her divine consciousness¹ to penetrate those clay statues and quietly examine them.

Baili Shi Qi quickly covered her mouth and muttered to herself: "Bringing an aunt to eliminate ghosts—she must be a kind person."

"These corpses include men, women, and elderly, but no children." Ning Fu Yi spoke, "With so many corpses, and so many children in the village. If it were an ordinary fierce ghost, there'd be no reason to only target adults."

"When you heard the ghost rumors outside the mountain, did you hear anything else?" Ning Fu Yi turned back to ask Shi Qi.

Shi Qi's watery eyes looked up at the sky as she thought hard, then answered: "I didn't hear much else, only that Axe Head Village was haunted, that the death scenes were all bizarre, and that ghost only attacked isolated people. So among the village's hundreds of people, no one has actually seen the ghost."

"No one has actually seen the ghost..." Ning Fu Yi repeated her answer, but suddenly said "not good" and lifted her legs to rush back. Her slender body leaped onto the divine sword, streaking into the rain curtain like a meteor.

"What, do you know where that thing is? Are you afraid it will hurt people?" Shi Qi quickly caught up, asking while chasing.

"No, I'm afraid of hurting it!" Ning Fu Yi said through gritted teeth.

The two flew on their swords, and in no time they had returned to the village. The rain was lessening, the wind broke through the thick haze above, revealing the normal deep blue night sky.

Ning Fu Yi put away her divine sword while still in mid-air and leaped to Chu Qing Qiu's door. As soon as she landed, she saw the door fly out, divine light rippling forth, and shrill screams echoing in the narrow room.

Ning Fu Yi dodged the door and hurriedly shouted: "Wait! Chu Qing Qiu!"

Her timely shout made the white bone² change direction mid-flight, not shattering the ghost. Chu Qing Qiu's lotus-white arm turned, and the woman's body was thrown out of the room, rolling into the muddy ground.

Then a transparent barrier descended from the sky, completely covering the woman. The woman began screaming again in agony, her haggard yet beautiful face gradually tearing apart, revealing another rotting face underneath.

Shi Qi, who had just landed, was stunned. She exclaimed in awe, looking admiringly at Chu Qing Qiu.

"I fought with this fierce ghost for a long time but was defeated, yet now it can be made to show its true form with just one move—how amazing!" She praised repeatedly.

"Wait a moment." Ning Fu Yi quickly stepped forward and held down Chu Qing Qiu's hand. She was still dripping with water all over, and her hands were cold too. Chu Qing Qiu looked at the young lady with water droplets hanging on her eyelashes and frowned for a moment.

"What happened?" she asked.

Ning Fu Yi quickly recounted what had just happened, then said: "I thought this thing doesn't kill children, so perhaps it was a mother in life. And hearing that it only attacks isolated people, I remembered that Qiu Lan was present when Da Lang died, so I guessed there must be something suspicious about Qiu Lan."

Now looking at it, she had guessed correctly.

Chu Qing Qiu had always been merciless toward demons and monsters. Afraid she would directly blast the ghost soul away with one palm, Ning Fu Yi had rushed back urgently.

While Ning Fu Yi was speaking, her hair was still seeping water, flowing down her tender neck. Chu Qing Qiu looked away and took out a dry handkerchief from her sleeve, pressing it against Ning Fu Yi's face.

Then she turned toward the spirited Shi Qi beside them, her peach blossom eyes half-lowered: "Who are you?"

Upon hearing this, Shi Qi pursed her lips and stood properly, bowing respectfully: "I am Baili Shi Qi, a new friend of Sister Ning, from Penglai Realm³."

"Sister Ning, this must be Sister Ning's aunt, right?" Her fruit-like face smiled sweetly, "Shi Qi greets Auntie!"

Footnotes:

1. **Divine consciousness (神识):** A cultivator's spiritual awareness that can be projected to sense and communicate telepathically
2. **White bone (白骨):** Chu Qing Qiu's signature weapon, a bone-white staff/flute with divine properties
3. **Penglai Realm (蓬莱境):** One of the immortal realms, traditionally associated with wealthy and noble cultivator families